

THE SMALL VOICE

A Digital Platform for Discovery, Learning & Spiritual Growth

PREPARED FOR

Prospective Partners, Backers & Collaborators

PROJECT PHASE

Minimum Viable Product (Phase 1) — Vertical Slice of Full Ecosystem

DOCUMENT DATE

“Awaken. Build. Send. Multiply.”

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Executive Summary

The Small Voice is a digital platform designed to help anyone, anywhere begin and grow in a genuine relationship with God through storytelling, teaching, digital media, practical tools, guided learning, and community. It is built around a simple but powerful premise: people do not need more content — they need a clear, well-designed path from discovery to understanding, from understanding to practice, and from practice to meaningful action.

Rather than launching as an undifferentiated content site, The Small Voice is architected from day one as a modular ecosystem with four integrated pillars — **Stories, Resources, Learning, and Digital Tools** — unified by a single guiding journey: *Discover* → *Explore* → *Encounter* → *Grow* → *Belong* → *Live* → *Send* → *Multiply*. This structure allows the platform to start small, as a focused and shippable MVP, while preserving a clear and credible path to a much larger product.

This document presents the complete product concept, the underlying technical architecture, the phased delivery plan for an initial MVP, and the longer-term roadmap that extends the platform into a full knowledge, learning, and community ecosystem. It is written to give any reader — technical or non-technical — a clear and complete picture of what is being built, why it matters, and how it will be delivered.

Highlight	Detail
Product type	Content, learning & community platform (web application)
Core users	Public visitors, registered authors/contributors, and platform administrators
MVP delivery model	10-day, milestone-based build of a functioning vertical slice
Core technology	React frontend, FastAPI backend, PostgreSQL database, containerized deployment
Differentiator	A single connected journey across content, learning, tools and community — not a disconnected blog
Long-term direction	Evolves from publishing platform to full discipleship & learning ecosystem across seven phases

Vision & Mission

Mission Statement

The Small Voice exists to help anyone, anywhere begin and grow in a genuine relationship with God through storytelling, teaching, digital media, practical tools, and guided learning, moving people from discovery to growth and from growth to action.

The Internal Product Loop

Internally, the product strategy is organized around a simple operating model that connects the platform's purpose to its features:

Stage	What it means	What it includes
Awaken	Help people see truth and reality clearly	Stories, testimonies, media, questions, cultural conversation
Build	Help people grow in knowledge, character, and capability	Teaching, courses, resources, spiritual practices, leadership
Send	Help people move from consumption to participation	Service, mission, evangelism, community projects, leadership
Multiply	Help the people who were helped become the ones who help others	Contributor pathway, story-sharing, creator tools

Guiding Boundary

The platform is intentionally designed as a **bridge, not a destination**. It does not attempt to replace the Church, Scripture, Christian community, or genuine human relationships. Its explicit goal is to move people from the screen into real practice and real community — a distinction that shapes both the product philosophy and the specific features described in this document.

The Opportunity

Most content platforms in this space fall into one of a few narrow categories: a blog or news site that only publishes articles, a resource library that only hosts downloads, a learning management system that only delivers courses, or a media app that only streams video or audio. Each does one job reasonably well, but none of them connect discovery, understanding, practice and community into a single, coherent experience.

The Small Voice is designed to close that gap. A single story, resource, or course is treated as an entry point into a connected ecosystem rather than an isolated artifact. A reader who arrives through one article about purpose, identity, or faith can move seamlessly into related teaching, a relevant downloadable resource, a short guided course, and a practical digital tool that helps them act on what they have learned — without ever hitting a dead end.

Why Now

- Smartphone and internet access continue to expand access to digital content across regions and demographics, lowering the barrier to reach a wide, global audience.
- Attention-driven platforms optimize for time-on-app rather than genuine growth; there is a clear opening for a platform that explicitly optimizes for transformation and real-world action instead.
- Modern, well-understood web technology (React, FastAPI, PostgreSQL) makes it realistic to build a credible, production-grade MVP in a matter of days rather than months, and to scale it incrementally afterward.

Product Overview

The platform is organized around four connected pillars. Together they form a single ecosystem rather than four separate products.

Pillar	Purpose	Examples
Stories	Create emotional and intellectual entry points into deeper content	Articles, testimonies, news, opinion pieces, short documentaries
Resources	Give people something tangible to keep, read, or reference	Books, PDFs, study guides, templates, infographics, audio/video
Learning	Turn passive reading into structured, guided understanding	Short courses composed of lessons, readings, and simple assessments
Digital Tools	Turn understanding into practice	Prayer prompts, guided Bible reading, a reflective journal, scripture memory practice

Positioning

The product is deliberately **not** positioned as “another blog.” The homepage, navigation, and content model are all built around a single question the platform answers for every visitor: *what should I do next?* Every piece of content, resource, and tool exists to give a clear, low-friction answer to that question.

The User Journey

At the center of the product is a single journey loop that every feature is designed to serve. It is not a rigid, one-directional funnel — a person can enter or re-enter it at any stage.

Stage	What happens
Discover	A visitor encounters a story, headline, video, or idea — often through search or social sharing.
Explore	Related topics, tags, and stories widen the entry point into a small topic-based ecosystem.
Encounter	Teaching and Scripture content introduce core ideas: the Gospel, God, Jesus, faith.
Grow	Courses, resources, and tools deepen understanding and build a practice.
Belong	The platform connects the person to community — groups, mentors, and local or online fellowship.
Live	The person applies what they have learned: serving, creating, and practicing in daily life.
Send	The person takes on mission-oriented action: evangelism, leadership, or service.
Multiply	The person becomes a contributor — sharing their own story, resource, or course for the next visitor.

Meeting People Where They Are

The platform does not assume a single starting point. A visitor who has never encountered Christian faith, one who has walked away from it, and one who is already an active believer are each offered a distinct, relevant next step rather than a generic, one-size-fits-all homepage.

User Roles & Permissions

The platform is built around three roles. Access control is enforced entirely on the backend — the interface never determines what a user is allowed to do; it only reflects what the server has already authorized.

Visitor (Public, No Account Required)

- Browse and read all published stories and teaching content
- Search and filter by topic, category, or tag
- Preview and download public resources
- Cannot create, edit, or manage any content, and cannot access the admin dashboard

Author / Contributor (Registered Account)

- Register, log in, and manage a personal profile
- Create stories, resources, and (in later phases) course content
- Save drafts, upload cover images and downloadable files
- Submit content for editorial review; track approval status
- Cannot publish content directly or manage other users' content

Admin (Editorial & Platform Control)

- Review, approve, or reject submitted content
- Edit or remove any content on the platform
- Manage user accounts, categories, tags, and comments
- View platform analytics: downloads, popular content, pending submissions
- Full configuration access to platform settings

Content Workflow

All author-submitted content follows a single, consistent workflow, which is one of the platform's core technical building blocks:

Step	State	Who acts
1	Draft	Author writes and saves privately
2	Pending Review	Author submits for publication
3	Published or Rejected	Admin approves or returns it with feedback

Content Architecture

Content is modeled as distinct, purpose-built types rather than a single generic “post” table. This keeps the product flexible as new formats are added and allows each content type to carry the metadata it actually needs.

Content Type	Formats Included	Primary Purpose
Story	Article, news, opinion, testimony	Emotional and intellectual entry point
Resource	Book, PDF, guide, template, infographic, audio, video	Tangible, keepable material
Learning	Course, lesson, video lesson, reading, simple assessment	Structured, guided understanding

Discovery Layer: Topics & Tags

Every content item carries topic tags (for example, Purpose, Identity, Faith, Prayer, Leadership). Tapping a tag opens a dedicated topic page that pulls together every relevant story, teaching resource, course, and tool — turning a single article into a doorway into the wider platform rather than a dead end.

Content Pillars Snapshot

Layer	Contains
Discovery	Stories, media, explore/topic pages
Understanding	Resources, learning courses, digital tools
Practice	Growth tracking, journaling, guided exercises
Belonging	Community groups, mentorship, local/online connections

Product Principles

These principles are treated as design constraints, not aspirational language. Every feature decision in this document is checked against them.

Principle	What it means in practice
Relationship over information	The goal is growth in relationship, not merely accumulating knowledge.
Transformation over consumption	Content is designed to lead to reflection, practice, and action.
Accessibility over complexity	Anyone with a smartphone and an internet connection can begin.
Truth over trends	The platform's message is not shaped by engagement metrics.
Story over abstraction	Ideas are made tangible and memorable through narrative.
Practice over performance	Growth indicators reflect activity and engagement, never spiritual worth.
Digital as a bridge, not a destination	Technology is built to move people toward real, offline life and community.
Multiply, not merely accumulate	A growing user is deliberately guided toward eventually helping others grow.

Technical Architecture

The platform is built on a conventional, well-supported, and highly hireable technology stack. This is a deliberate choice: it minimizes technical risk, keeps the codebase maintainable, and makes it straightforward to bring on additional developers as the platform grows.

Layer	Technology	Role
Frontend	React	Public site, author dashboard, admin dashboard (single codebase, role-based views)
API layer	FastAPI (Python)	REST API handling authentication, content, users, and business logic
Database	PostgreSQL	Relational storage for users, content, categories, comments, downloads
File storage	Object/file storage service	Cover images, downloadable resources, media files
Deployment	Docker Compose / containerized hosting	Reproducible environment across development and production
Optional (future)	AI API integration	Search, recommendations, content assistance — explicitly deferred from MVP

A Core Engineering Principle

Interface-level restrictions (for example, hiding an admin menu from a non-admin user) are treated purely as user-experience conveniences. Every permission is enforced independently on the backend: the API verifies who the user is, what role they hold, and whether that role is authorized for the specific action being requested, on every single request.

Project Structure

The codebase is organized into a clearly separated frontend and backend, each with its own internal structure for pages, components, API routes, data models, and services. This separation keeps the system easy to reason about as new features (courses, tools, community) are added in later phases.

Data Model Overview

The MVP database is intentionally lean, with a clear path to extend it as later phases (courses, community, tools) are introduced.

Table	Key Fields	Notes
users	id, name, email, password hash, role, created_at	Only authors and admins require accounts; visitors do not
content	id, title, slug, type, body, cover image, author id, category id, status, timestamps	A single flexible table for stories and resources in the MVP
categories	id, name, slug, description	e.g., Faith, Leadership, Technology, Culture, Mission
comments	id, content id, user id, body, status, created_at	Requires a registered account to submit
downloads	id, content id, downloaded_at	Powers basic analytics on resource popularity

Planned Extensions (Post-MVP)

- courses, lessons — structured learning content, linked to content items
- media, tags — richer classification and asset management
- views — engagement analytics beyond downloads
- groups, mentorship — the community layer described in Phase 5 of the roadmap

MVP Scope — Phase 1

The MVP is scoped as a complete, coherent “vertical slice” of the full vision described in this document: a working publishing and resource platform with authentication, roles, a review workflow, and basic discovery — built so that learning, tools, and community can be layered on without a rebuild.

In Scope for the MVP

- Public site: home, browse stories/resources, story detail, category and tag browsing, search
- Visitor access with no account required for reading, browsing, and downloading
- Author registration, login, and a personal dashboard for creating and managing content
- Draft → Submit → Review → Publish/Reject workflow
- Admin dashboard: content review, user management, category management, comment moderation
- File handling: cover images and downloadable resource files (e.g., PDFs)
- Basic analytics: download counts, most-viewed and most-downloaded content

Explicitly Out of Scope for the MVP

- Structured courses and lesson progress tracking (Phase 3)
- Digital spiritual-practice tools such as guided prayer or scripture memory (Phase 3–4)
- Community features such as groups and mentorship matching (Phase 5)
- Personalized recommendations and AI-assisted discovery (Phase 6–7)

This scoping discipline is intentional: it keeps the initial build shippable in a realistic timeframe while ensuring every architectural decision supports the larger roadmap.

Development Plan & Timeline

The MVP is delivered as a 10-day, milestone-based build. Each day produces a working, testable increment rather than an isolated piece of unintegrated code.

Day	Milestone	Deliverable
1	Foundations	Project skeleton, environment, and tooling in place
2	Core API	Content API (create, read, update, delete) running on temporary in-memory data
3	Database	PostgreSQL schema live; content now persists across restarts
4	Frontend shell	Home, browse, detail, login, and register pages built against sample data
5	Full-stack integration	Frontend connected end-to-end to the live API and database
6	Authentication & roles	Registration, login, password hashing, JWT sessions, role-based access
7	Author workflow	Create, draft, edit, submit-for-review flow fully functional
8	Admin dashboard	Review, approve/reject, manage users, categories, and comments
9	Files & polish	Cover images, file downloads, search, pagination; UI clean-up
10	Testing & ship	End-to-end role testing across visitor, author, and admin; deployment

Acceptance Checklist at Launch

Role	Must be able to	Must NOT be able to
Visitor	Browse, search, read, and download	Access any admin or authoring feature
Author	Register, log in, create and edit own content, submit for review	Publish directly or manage other users' content
Admin	Approve/reject content, manage users, categories, and comments	—

Product Roadmap

The MVP is the first of seven planned phases. Each phase builds directly on the data model and architecture established in the phase before it, so no phase requires re-architecting the platform from scratch.

Phase	Focus	What it adds
1	Publishing Platform	Stories, resources, roles, review workflow (the MVP described in this document)
2	Resource Library	Expanded resource types, richer filtering, curated collections
3	Online Learning	Structured courses, lessons, and progress tracking
4	Digital Tools	Guided prayer, scripture reading, journaling, and practice tools
5	Community	Groups, mentorship, and connections from digital to real-world relationships
6	Personalized Growth	Individual growth journeys tailored to where each person is starting from
7	AI-Assisted Discovery	Smarter search, recommendations, and content assistance for creators

Why a Phased Approach

Building the full ecosystem in one pass would be slow, expensive, and risky. Sequencing the phases this way lets the platform earn real usage and feedback from Phase 1 onward, validating the core product before investing further engineering effort into learning, tools, and community features.

Success Metrics

Because the platform's stated goal is transformation rather than attention, its metrics are chosen to reflect genuine engagement and progression through the journey — not simply time spent on the site.

Category	Example Metrics
Reach	Unique visitors, story views, search usage, referral sources
Engagement depth	Resource downloads, return visits, topic/tag exploration paths
Conversion into the journey	Visitor-to-registered-author conversion, account creation rate
Content health	Submission volume, review turnaround time, approval/rejection rate
Platform reliability	Uptime, API response time, error rate

As later phases introduce courses, tools, and community, this metric set will expand to include course completion rates, tool usage frequency, and the number of contributors moving from consumer to creator — but explicitly not a spiritual “score” or leaderboard of any kind, consistent with the product principles in Section 8.

Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Scope creep beyond the MVP before it ships	Strict phase boundaries (Section 11); later-phase features are explicitly deferred, not partially built
Security gaps in role-based access	All permissions enforced server-side; no reliance on hiding interface elements
Low initial content volume	Editorial workflow supports a small internal or founding contributor team ahead of public launch
Platform drifting into pure content consumption	Product principles (Section 8) and metrics (Section 14) explicitly favor practice and action over time-on-site
Technical maintainability as scope grows	Conventional, well-documented stack (React, FastAPI, PostgreSQL) chosen specifically for long-term maintainability

Conclusion

The Small Voice is designed to be more than a publishing website. Its content, learning, tools, and community features are not separate products bolted together — they are different doors into a single, connected journey: *Discover → Explore → Encounter → Grow → Belong → Live → Send → Multiply*.

The plan set out in this document is deliberately realistic: a focused, ten-day MVP builds the first working slice of that journey on a solid, conventional technical foundation, with a clear, phased path toward the full vision. Every architectural and product decision in the MVP is made with the later phases already in mind, so that growth does not require starting over.

The Small Voice exists to help anyone, anywhere begin and grow in a genuine relationship with God through storytelling, teaching, digital media, practical tools, and guided learning, moving people from discovery to growth and from growth to action.

AWAKEN • BUILD • SEND • MULTIPLY